

## PRELUDE VI

THE best results are given here by a *legatissimo* touch throughout, with constant grip of harmonic detail and melodic outline in all three notes of the triplet—e.g., the third notes throughout bars 6-14, and from bar 10 onwards the other notes besides. The repeated notes in the bass should be almost tied, like the quavers in Chopin's B minor Prelude. The *tempo* is a very moderate four in the bar, but not an eight. The first note in the right hand should be

understood as the end of a triplet; thus 

The climax is built up with great boldness and subtlety by means of a pedal point, not on the usual dominant, but on the tonic, beginning at bar 15. The sudden plunge in the bass from the tonic to G# in bar 21, and the chromatic steps from thence around the dominant are matters of great moment. Notice also the F#, Eb, and D in the second half of bar 20 in sixths with the left hand. The G# at the end of bar 22 is another powerful rhetorical point in this most impassioned movement. (Make no mistake about the C# in the sixth quaver of bar 21).

The last chords should be slightly broken. Two of the autographs tie the treble D's—a reading which Bach rejects elsewhere as producing a bad effect of octaves with the bass.

## FUGUE VI

THE Subject, which is treated by Inversion and in various kinds of Stretto, is also to be brought out distinctly even in those entries which represent merely its first figure, or which (as in bars 8-9) come in a new part of the scale and alter its intervals.

The slur, *staccato* dash, and shake in bar 2 are Bach's own marks, and should be carefully reproduced in all complete entries, direct and inverted. Some good MSS., and most old printed editions, have turns ( ~ ) on the third crotchets of bars 9-11. This is an anachronism belonging to no style before that of C. P. E. Bach, and conceivable only in a *tempo* far too lively for the expression of the Countersubject and such complex modulations as those of bars 15-16. What the Episode of bars 9-11 really demands on the third crotchet is either another *staccato* mark, as given by Bach himself in the parallel passage (bars 30-32), or the thematic shake, which should always have its final turn.

The Countersubject (which is sometimes shared between two parts) demands an expressive *cantabile* tone and quite as much distinctness as the Subject. Its final crotchets in bar 5 do not allude to the Subject, and should therefore (in spite of good MS. authority) not be detached. Nor should its second semiquaver figure (bars 4-5) become confused with the semiquaver group in the Subject, which Bach has phrased specially. It will produce all the more effect when it drifts into the second bar of the Subject in bar 12. It underlies the Episode of bars 9-11, and its later free permutation in bars 30-32; and it is inverted in bars 25-26, over a figure of the inverted subject. The first figure of the Countersubject is developed in bars 15-16, and comes to a climax in bars 36-38. The bass entry of the Subject in bar 34 did not originally fill its crotchets out with quavers in bar 35; but Bach found himself compelled to make this variation in order to avoid octaves with the treble.

The four bars 17-20, closing in the dominant, are reproduced with decidedly symmetrical effect in the tonic in bars 39-42. (The autographs are all against reading C# in the bass of bar 40; but it is required by the sense and the parallel with bar 18.)

A.B. 99.